Mouldy Bread

Aim: To investigate factors which cause mould/fungi to grow

Equipment:

- 4 slices of bread
- 4 re-sealable food bags
- 2 paper towels
- Water
- Marker pen and labels

Safety Information

mould/fungi – harmful, risk of aerosol if opened.

Keep the bag sealed, observe through the transparent sides.

Method:

Step 1: Stick a label on each bag and write your name on it.

Step 2: Put a slice of bread in the first bag. Seal and label as 'dry/light'.

Step 3: Put a slice of bread and a damp paper towel in the second bag. Seal and label as 'damp/light'.

Step 4: Put a slice of bread in the third bag. Seal and label as 'dry/dark'.

Step 5: Put a slice of bread and a damp paper towel in the fourth bag. Seal and label as 'damp/dark'.

Step 6: Put the first two bags ('light') onto a sunny windowsill.

Step 7: Put the third and fourth bags ('dark') into a dark cupboard.

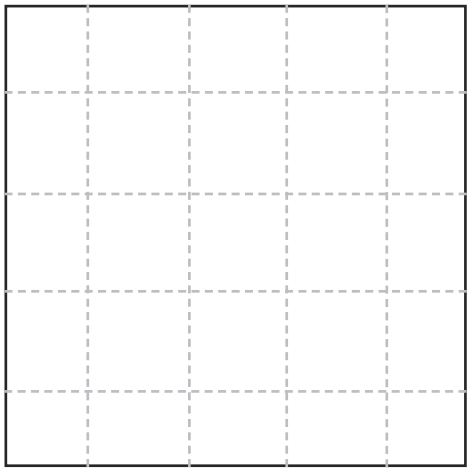
Step 8: Leave the bread at least five days.



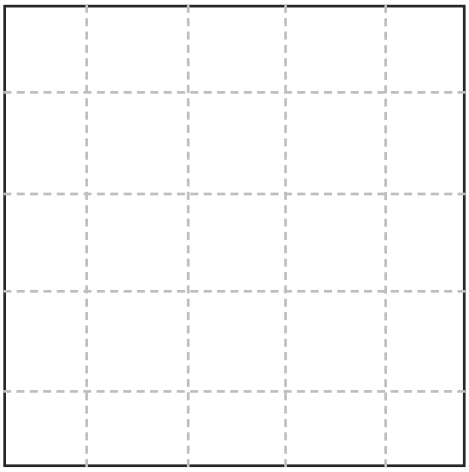
visit twinkl.com

Questions:

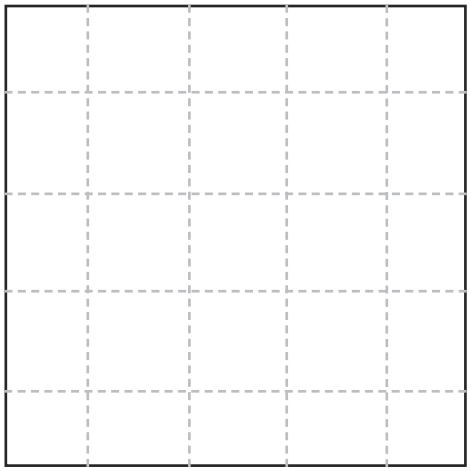
1. Draw a sketch of each slice of bread. Estimate the percentage coverage of mould/fungi per slice.



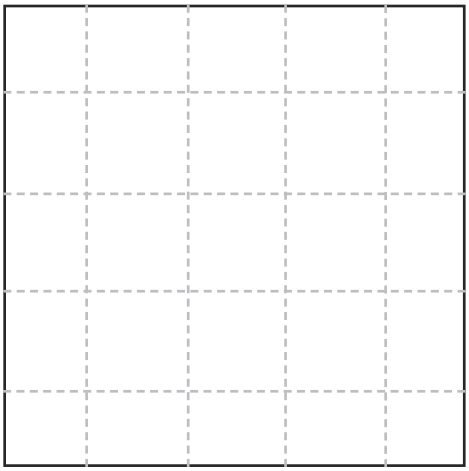
Dry/light conditions ____ %



Dry/light conditions ____ %



Dry/light conditions ____ %



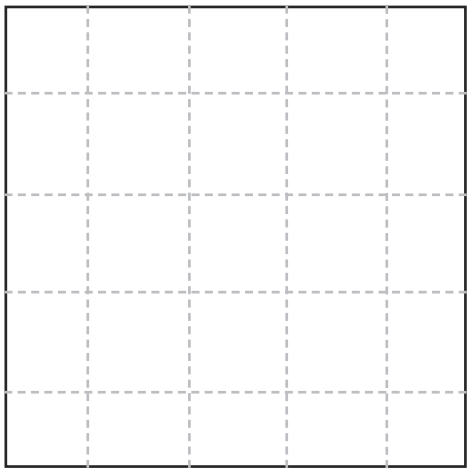
Dry/light conditions ____ %

2. Which conditions caused the most mould/fungi growth?
3. How might you store food to avoid decay and mould/fungi?

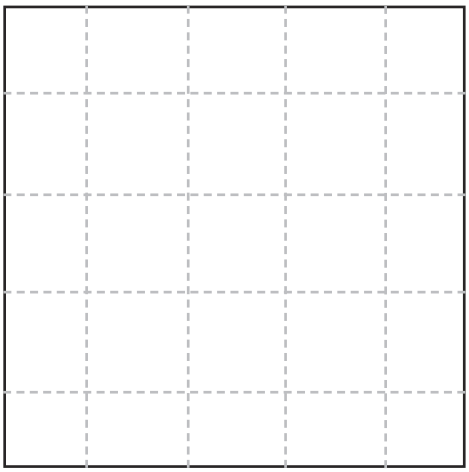
visit twinkl.com

Answers

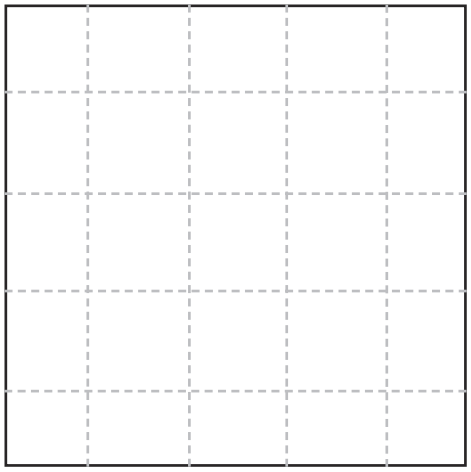
1. Draw a sketch of each slice of bread. Estimate the percentage coverage of mould/fungi per slice.



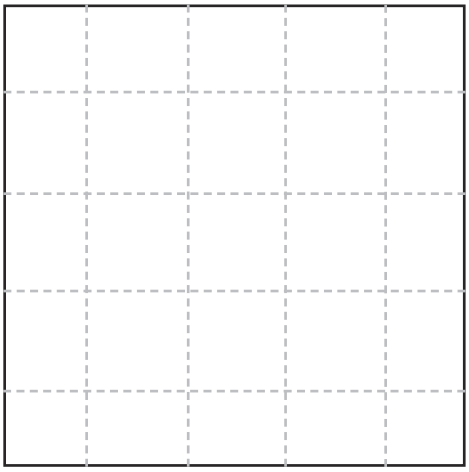
Dry/light conditions ____ %



Dry/light conditions ____ %



Dry/light conditions ____ %



Dry/light conditions ____ %

Sketches should be accurate to their different, observable results. Students should indicate the presence of mould/fungi by shaded areas/dots, etc.

The percentage coverage should be estimated from the grid – each square is equivalent to 4%.

2. Which conditions caused the most mould/fungi growth?
   The most growth should be found on the bread stored in the damp/dark conditions.

3. How might you store food to avoid decay and mould/fungi?
   Food should be stored in a cool and dry area to limit mould/fungi growth and decay.